

Statement of Work (SOW)

Sole Source License and Maintenance – Careware Nurse Self-Scheduling and Productivity System

1. Purpose

The purpose of this acquisition is to provide continued licensing, maintenance, and support for the Careware Nurse Self-Scheduling and Productivity System currently deployed within the NIH Clinical Center Nursing Department. This system improves efficiency in generating monthly staff schedules and provides critical data to support budgetary planning and staffing decisions. This is a sole source requirement to ensure uninterrupted system availability and operational continuity

2. Background

The National Institutes of Health (NIH), within the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services (HHS), operates the Clinical Center (CC) in Bethesda, Maryland—the nation’s largest hospital dedicated to clinical research.

The Clinical Center Nursing Department includes approximately 701 FTEs, 3-day hospitals, over 19 outpatient clinics, and approximately 14 inpatient units supporting continuous (24/7/365) clinical operations. The primary mission of the Nursing Department is to support clinical research by delivering compassionate, evidence-based nursing care to a diverse population of patients and their families, while ensuring safe, high quality patient care.

The Careware system is currently used to:

- Develop and manage nursing staff schedules
- Support workload balancing and staffing level optimization
- Supporting adequate staffing levels and skill mix
- Reducing risks associated with understaffing or staff fatigue
- Enhance overall patient care quality.
- Provide data for staffing, budgeting, and operational decision-making
- Enhance operational effectiveness, improve outcomes and reduce waste.

The system is fully integrated into current nursing workflows and operations.

3. Objective

The objective of this requirement is to maintain full operational capability of the existing Careware system through continued licensing, maintenance, and technical support without interruption.

4. Scope of Work

The Contractor (Care Systems) shall provide all necessary licenses, maintenance, and support services required to sustain the existing Careware Nurse Self-Scheduling and Productivity System.

The Contractor shall:

- Provide nurse self-scheduling and productivity system that functions as a single, integrated solution.
- Ensure the system remains fully operational, is reliable and continues to meet existing performance requirements.
- Provide software updates, patches, and bug fixes as released
- Provide all required software licenses for continued system use
- Provide technical support, including troubleshooting and issue resolution
- Maintain compatibility with the current NIH Clinical Center environment

No system reconfiguration, redesign, or new implementation is required under this effort.

5. Sole Source Justification (Operational Context)

The Clinical Center Nursing Department operates in a fast-paced and highly complex clinical environment, where efficient workforce management is critical to ensuring safe, high-quality patient care. The need for a comprehensive scheduling and productivity system is essential to effectively manage nursing staff, optimize workloads, and maintain appropriate staffing levels across patient care units. This type of system also provides productivity data that informs budget planning and contributes to cost-effective decision making.

Care Systems is the original developer and sole provider of the Careware system. As the system is fully implemented and integrated into daily nursing operations, continuation with the current vendor eliminates the need for additional installation, data migration, transition or training costs. It also ensures support for critical staff functions as well as reduced operational costs associated with staff retraining or potential disruption to patient care services. Continued support by the original vendor is required to:

- Ensure uninterrupted access to proprietary software and licensing
- Maintain system integrity and data continuity
- Avoid unacceptable risk to clinical operations caused by system disruption

- Prevent additional costs and delays associated with transitioning to an alternate vendor during ongoing operations

No other vendor can provide the required proprietary licenses, maintenance, and support services for the existing system.

6. Contract Type and Period of Performance

- **Contract Type:** Firm-Fixed-Price (FFP)
 - **Period of Performance:** July 1, 2026 – June 30, 2027
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7. Hours of Operation

The NIH Clinical Center operates **24 hours per day, 365 days per year**.

The Contractor shall provide maintenance and support services on a **24/7/365 basis**, including all Federal holidays.

The ten Federal holidays currently observed are:

- New Year's Day
- Martin Luther King, Jr. Day
- Washington's Birthday (Presidents Day)
- Memorial Day
- Juneteenth National Independence Day
- Independence Day
- Labor Day
- Columbus Day
- Veterans Day
- Thanksgiving Day
- Christmas Day

This also includes any additional day declared a Federal holiday by the President of the United States.

8. Place of Performance

Primary place of performance:

NIH Clinical Center
9000 Rockville Pike
Building 10
Bethesda, MD 20892

Services may be performed remotely as appropriate.

9. Security Requirements

All Contractor personnel must obtain and maintain an NIH Contractor Badge, including completion of background investigations and required annual training.

The Contractor shall:

- Safeguard all Government systems, data, and property
 - Comply with NIH security and access control policies
 - Ensure proper control of any Government-issued credentials or access devices
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10. Government Oversight

The Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) will provide technical oversight and monitor Contractor performance.

COR:

Teresa McDivitt
NIH Clinical Center Nursing Department

The Government may conduct periodic performance reviews at no additional cost.

11. Data Rights

All data generated, maintained, or processed under this contract remains the property of the Government.

The Contractor shall not use, disclose, or distribute Government data without prior written approval from the Contracting Officer.

12. Organizational Conflict of Interest

The Contractor shall comply with FAR Subpart 9.5 and disclose any actual or potential Organizational Conflict of Interest (OCI). Mitigation plans must be submitted for Government approval.
